

Jamiatul Ulama Johannesburg

الستر ولباس الصلاة الصحيح

Satr-e-Aurah & Valid Ṣalāh Attire

PDF · 8 pages · Fiqh of Ṣalāh



وما علينا إلا البلاغ المبين

"Clear propagation is our only responsibility." — Sūrah Yāsīn 36:17

The Condition of Satr in Ṣalāh

شرط الستر في الصلاة

The concealment of the satr (the must-be-covered parts of the body) is a condition (shart) for the validity of Ṣalāh. This is among the shurūṭ al-ṣalāh (the conditions that must be met before takbīr al-taḥrīmah).

For a male: from the navel to (and including) the knees.

For a free female: the entire body except the face and the hands (up to and including the wrists).

This concealment requires:

1. That the entire area be covered.
2. That the form (shape) of the satr-e-ghaleez not be revealed — not merely that the skin be covered by cloth.
3. That the colour of the skin not show through (the cloth must be opaque).

Source: Al-Hidāyah · Radd al-Muḥtār



Tight Clothing and Ṣalāh

اللباس الضيق والصلاة

A common error in our time is the wearing of tight, form-fitting clothing during Ṣalāh. This includes:

- Tight jeans, especially in the sajdah posture, which reveal the form of the satr-e-ghaleez.
- Tight shorts that ride above the knee in rukū' or sajdah.
- Leggings or tight trousers.
- Tight T-shirts that outline the body.

Such clothing breaks the condition of satr concealment, because the form (shakl) of the satr is revealed — even though the skin is technically covered. Ṣalāh in such attire is invalid (bāṭil) and must be repeated.

This is the explicit verdict of the Ḥanafī fuqahā.

Source: Radd al-Muḥtār · Al-Durr al-Mukhtār



What Constitutes Proper Ṣalāh Attire

اللباس الصحيح للصلاة

For the male:

- A loose lower garment (izar, lungi, or loose trousers) that covers from the navel to below the knee, with room to spare so the form is not revealed.
- A loose upper garment (qamīṣ/kurta or a loose shirt) that covers the upper body.
- The Sunnah attire — a loose izar and a loose qamīṣ — is the most complete answer.

For the female:

- A loose jilbāb that covers the entire body except the face and hands.
- A khimar (head-covering) that covers the head, neck, and chest.
- The garment must be opaque and not reveal the form of the body.

Loose trousers that cover below the knees with room to spare are acceptable for men, provided they do not resemble kuffār-style dress or be so tight as to reveal the form.

Source: Fatāwā Hindiyyah · Bahishti Zewar



Common Errors in Modern Dress

أخطاء شائعة في اللباس الحديث

1. Wearing tight jeans or trousers to the masjid and then performing Ṣalāh in them — the Ṣalāh is invalid.
2. Wearing shorts that cover the knees while standing but ride up during rukū' or sajdah, exposing the satr — invalidates the Ṣalāh.
3. Wearing clothing with images of animate life (humans, animals) — disliked (makrūh) in Ṣalāh; the Ṣalāh is valid but the reward is diminished.
4. Wearing clothing with English text or unsuitable slogans — disliked.
5. Wearing clothing that is transparent or sheer — invalidates the Ṣalāh.

6. Performing Ṣalāh with the 'awrah exposed (e.g. due to a short shirt that exposes the back during sajdah) — invalidates the Ṣalāh if the exposure is for the duration of a rukn.

Source: Fatāwā Hindiyyah · Fatāwā Maḥmūdiyyah



The Principle of Sincerity in Dress

مبدأ الإخلاص في اللباس

إن الله لا ينظر إلى صوركم وأموالكم ولكن ينظر إلى قلوبكم وأعمالكم

The Prophet ﷺ said: "Indeed, Allah does not look at your forms and your wealth, but He looks at your hearts and your deeds." (Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2564)

This does not mean that dress is irrelevant — the conditions of satr must be met for the validity of Ṣalāh, and the Sunnah of dress should be observed as an expression of devotion. But the heart's intention is what Allah sees.

A Muslim's dress should be:

- Modest, conforming to the Shar'ī requirements.
- Clean and presentable, for Ṣalāh especially.
- Distinct, not imitating the kuffār.
- Free from ostentation (riyā') — not worn to show off.

May Allah grant us sincerity in our inward and outward.

Source: Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2564



جمعية العلماء جوهانسبرغ

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وما علينا إلا البلاغ المبين